Midds Reef

An artificial surf reef planned for Middleton Beach

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DESCRIPTION

The city of Albany in Western Australia is home to an artificial surfing reef called the Southern Ocean Surf Reef (SOSR) off Middleton Beach, hence the nickname “Midds Reef”. The reef, constructed using rocks, sits about 120 meters off shore an creates a left that, on typical swells, is suitable for beginners and intermediates. On larger swells, the wave is more suitable for advanced surfers.

The reef refracts incoming swells to produce a left-hand break that runs for roughly 100m. The
Waves will break on the reef 40% of the year.

The reef was officially opened to the public on July 16, 2025.

DESIGN AND CONSTRUCTION

The southern coast of Western Australia is know for powerful swells generated by storms in th
beaches where frequent offshore winds help groom them. However, the monotonous shoreline

After years of work from community leader Peter Bolt, the city of Albany recognized the opport
development of an artificial surf reef at Middleton Beach. The reef could shape the incoming swells into consistently fun, surfable waves within close proximity to

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The city first hired Royal Haskoning DHV to conduct a in-depth feasibility assessment for the artificial surf reef in 2003. They recommended the use of geo-textile bags to form the reef.

After years of hurdles, hard work and grass-roots promotion, in 2012 the city engaged with Blue Coast Marine Engineers (including some of the same people who worked on the Palm Beach Reef) for additional analysis and design.

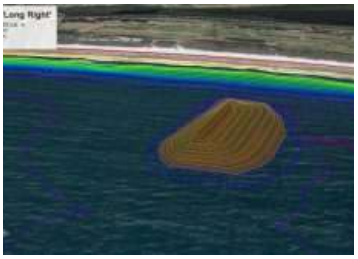
The Middleton Beach area has relatively low average swell height. However, analysis and modeling revealed that Middleton Beach possesses a number of very unique features that result in ideal conditions for an artificial surfing reef. Those include:

- Minimal tidal fluctuations which maximize the duration that swell will break on the reef structure
- An nearly unidirectional wave swell direction
- Relatively long period (12-16 sec) wave conditions which that result in significant wave increase in wave height as the swell interacts with the reef
- Natural wave focusing based on local bathymetry.

Blue Coast identified three reef design options and made recommendations that support the business case. The Steering Group selected the “Long Left” option, which has a total crest length of 120m. They selected that option because it will provide a better surfing experience than the alternatives and it will provide the best value in terms of length of ride per $.







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More waves, and a few moved rocks, at Southern Ocean Surf Reef

May 28, 2025 No Comment

Construction Underway on Southern Ocean Surf Reef

May 19, 2025 No Comment

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Detailed Design Starts on Albany Artificial Surf Reef

December 14, 2019 No Comment

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WAVE DATA

Open

0.8 – 1.3m Average Face Height

Left

100-120m

Breaking 40% of the Year

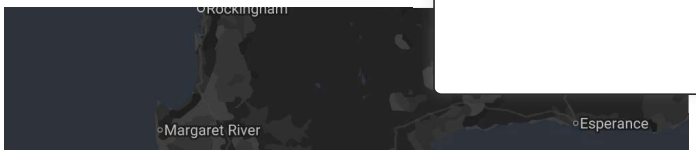
Easier Open Face, Good for Turns

BUSINESS INFO

Albany Western Australia, Australia

MAP

Get Direction



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